

Samsung Galaxy Buds2 Pro

Sonically brilliant

Samsung has been in the audio business for a few years now and a majority of the company's audio products we've reviewed have fared commendably in our tests. However, with the new Samsung Galaxy Buds2 Pro, Samsung has made a pair of truly wireless earphones we can truly deem to be fantastic when faced with competition. The specifications and features on offer are vast – rivalling big names from Sony, Sennheiser, Bose, and others. However, for an asking price of ₹17,999, the performance of these earphones must be top-tier. Let's see if these earbuds managed to match our expectations in this detailed review.

BUILD AND COMFORT

The Samsung Galaxy Buds2 Pro are strikingly compact. They're also undeniably premium-looking with a soft-touch matte finish on the case and the buds. The compact in-ear form factor is much appreciated since it is so much more inconspicuous than the stem-style buds made popular by the AirPods.

The earbuds are light enough at 5.5 g meaning you won't feel any discomfort when using them for long periods. The fit is also decent for most ears, but ear fins would be appreciated here.

The buds come with an IPX7 sweat and water resistance rating, so splashes and sweat will do no damage to them.

FEATURES

The Samsung Galaxy Buds2 Pro has almost every modern-day feature. However, one feature we found to be sorely missing was multipoint connectivity. While the Samsung Galaxy Buds2 Pro come packing a feature dubbed Auto Switch that can smartly switch between connected Samsung devices, not everyone is completely immersed in the Samsung ecosystem and this seems a very Apple thing to do – forcibly locking users into an ecosystem to make the most out of their device's features is not something



we appreciate. The Galaxy Wearable app (Android only) gives users access to a lot of customisation options. Sadly, there's no customisable equaliser which is disappointing, especially for its asking price.

Samsung's 360 audio with head tracking feature works a lot like Apple's Spatial Audio feature. We enjoyed using this and it does bump up the immersiveness to a great extent.

PERFORMANCE

Equipped with dual coaxial drivers and tuning done in collaboration with AKG, the Samsung Galaxy Buds2 Pro are the best-sounding pair of consumer-grade truly wireless earbuds we've tested in 2022. We tested the 24-bit audio on the Samsung Galaxy S22 Ultra on Amazon Music and while it sounded great, the use case is quite niche since it is only available on a Samsung device running One UI 4.0 or higher and on a couple of streaming services such as Tidal and Amazon Music. That aside, even on apps such as Spotify and YouTube Music, the Galaxy Buds2 Pro sound fantastic.

The buds provide an extremely musical and detailed sonic experience with full-sounding tunes and striking

mid-range clarity. The sound fidelity is unparalleled with the woofer and tweeter taking care of different parts of the sound frequency; ensuring there are no overlaps to cloud the details in the mix.

Powered by Bluetooth v5.3, the earbuds have impressive wireless connectivity as well with no instances of lag or stutter recorded during our testing phases. The Active Noise Cancellation is also impressive enough and the three high Signal-to-Noise ratio microphones in each earbud do a great job at capturing ambient noise and cancelling them with equal and opposite waves, especially in the low-end.

BATTERY LIFE

The Samsung Galaxy Buds2 Pro excel when it comes to sound quality, but they're just about average in terms of battery life. The earbuds come with a rated playtime of 5 hours on a single charge with ANC turned on; and 18

hours in total (5 hours on buds + 13 hours via case). In our tests, the earbuds lasted 4 hours and 32 minutes with ANC turned on, which is mediocre by 2022 standards. The earbuds do come with fast charging support though, so a quick 5-minute charge will give you an hour's worth of playlist.

VERDICT

We have no qualms recommending the Samsung Galaxy Buds2 Pro to those looking for a premium pair of truly wireless earphones. The Galaxy Buds2 Pro check almost every box, and the few misses can be overlooked thanks to fantastic audio tuning on the company's part. With the Galaxy Buds2 Pro, Samsung has set a new benchmark for not just itself but competing brands as well.

–Dhriti Datta

SPECIFICATIONS

Bluetooth: 5.3 | Bluetooth range: 10 m | Drivers: 10 mm Dynamic Driver tuned by AKG, 5.3 mm Tweeter | Audio codecs: 24-bit audio, SSC (Samsung Scalable Codec), AAC, SBC | Microphones: 6 high-SNR | Earbud: 5.5 g | IP Rating: IPX7 | Battery life: 5 hours on earbuds, 18 hours on charging case + earbuds | Colours: White, Graphite, Bora Purple

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